

Diwali Dhamaka

Digsters work hard to have fun

The end of the year is the season of festivities—Dassera, Diwali, Id and Christmas, all in one shiny sweet package. And festivities mean more than the sweets and gifts. It's the time of the year when everybody wants to spread cheer around the office space and hone their extra-curricular skills. So during one company meeting, our publisher and CEO, Maulik Jasubhai, announced that this Diwali party would require some participation from everyone. Since eager

beavers abound on such occasions, feet shuffled, throats cleared and eyes shifted

as everyone avoided looking anyone straight in the eye, lest it gets interpreted for enthusiasm. Expecting the opposition, Maulik just culled out a reluctant entertainment committee of nine random people from different departments. All murmurs of issue closing, deadlines, and psychosocial ineptitude for work were quickly and firmly dismissed. There was going to be a party and they had better make sure everyone enjoyed it.

So the committee sat down for meetings every day-end and came up with an entertainment plan—a one-act play and short mimicry item, something to suit everyone's palate. Once the programs were

planned out, it was time to delegate; this was their chance to get back at everyone who hadn't volunteered. They stalked near the printer and water cooler asking unsuspecting victims innocent questions like, "Aren't you interested in theatre?" or "Hey, someone told me you wanted to act. We're doing a play for the Diwali party, you know..."

The most convenient victims were the students at Media One, our in-house media school. When they turned in their 'project' on

playwriting, it magically transformed into the script for the play. Another colleague, very daringly, decided to perform a piece on the lives and workings of other departments.

At T minus 10, the actors woke up to the realisation that they had not rehearsed the play. So during the day, empty chairs and tables announced that their occupiers were busy with the party preparations. However, like all good things, everything went well, nobody forgot their lines or entries and we all partied on till the wee hours of the night.



Colleagues and the chairman, Mr Jasu Shah, enjoy the show



(Above) The cast of the play takes centre-stage.

(Right) An in-house actor gets happy with his toy gun



The cup runneth over

And with festivities in the air, can a gift be far behind? And what better gift for our readers than a year-end issue with two free CDs, six booklets and two CBTs, all served up with a beefy Digit containing a countdown of the best products of the year—the Zero1 Awards. Twenty-two pages of the best that technology has to offer of the year gone by, sifted from over 500 products that graced our Test Centre during 2002. Forty pages in Word peeled the skin off one very tired pair of hands, which swear they will never type again.

Marco D'Souza's mantle of Head Writer is a hard one to carry and is especially heavy when one has to analyse all the test databases of the year gone by, cross-check them and finally present them in jargon-free words. But there were far weightier problems than just the writing of the enormous cover story. Someone had to figure out how to put two CDs, two Fast Forwards, six booklets and one magazine together! Our designer, Ashwin, played tailor for the whole package, trying to find the perfect balance of stitching an

eye-catching design while keeping the assembly work involved for the production team in perspective. In the middle of it all, Vinit, our editor, decided to grow up and turn daddy to a little bundle of pink joy (so does this mean game CDs will make way for fluffy bunny rabbits?) Add to it the tortuous first month for our two new writers—Rachana and Srinivasan. They learnt the hard way that writing technology involves late nights, re-writes and editorial fights. Whew! Hope you all enjoy a fantastic Christmas! 